

Memo on the Flamingo Revolution

Last updated date: 29 June 2026

The unProtected Area

The Vjosa-Narta region is one of Albania's most valuable coastal landscapes and among the country's most important biodiversity hotspots. Stretching across lagoons, wetlands, coastal forests, marine habitats, and protected areas, it forms a unique ecological corridor along the Adriatic coast. Among the values added by this Protected Area are:

- **42 km²** of lagoon and wetland habitat.
- **194 km²** protected landscape combining river delta, forests, and coast.
- **200+** bird species recorded.
- **Thousands of flamingos** are observed annually.
- One of Albania's most important **wetlands** for migratory birds.
- Part of the **Adriatic Flyway**, used by birds moving between Europe and Africa.

Since late April, illegal construction activities have started in the Zvërnec area. Local residents, environmental organizations, and civil society groups argue that these works are taking place without sufficient public information regarding the project's scope, environmental studies, legal basis, or potential impacts.

The works are connected to plans for large-scale luxury tourism developments associated with investment interests linked to Jared Kushner, shady international firms, and local firms. These firms have fenced the area and secured it with private security guard firms who then forcefully clashed with the protesters physically.

Risks related to these interventions to the nature:

Risk	Severity	Scope
Risks to migratory bird populations and biodiversity . Disturbance of migration routes, habitat degradation, reduced breeding and wintering success for protected species	Very High	Entire Narta Lagoon ecosystem and Adriatic Flyway
Loss of wetlands, coastal forests, and wildlife habitats. Permanent habitat loss, ecosystem fragmentation, decline in biodiversity and ecosystem services.	Very High	Local and regional
Increased infrastructure pressure (roads, utilities, marinas, services). Fragmentation, pollution, urbanization, and increased human disturbance	High	Landscape-wide
Privatization of publicly accessible coastal landscapes. Reduced public access, restrictions on traditional uses, and transformation of public natural areas into private tourism facilities	High	Coastal strip, beaches, and surrounding public spaces

Table 1: Ecologic and natural risks from the intervention.

The Flamingo Revolution

Since early May, peaceful protests have continued across Albania in response to construction. What began as local opposition at the construction site has evolved into one of Albania's largest environmental and civic mobilizations in recent years, advocating for environmental protection, transparency, the rule of law and democratic accountability.

The movement brings together a broad coalition of stakeholders, including environmental organizations such as PPNEA, EcoAlbania, EuroNatur, BirdLife International and Riverwatch; Albanian and international scientists, biodiversity experts and academics; local communities; civil society organizations; youth groups; artists; public figures; and Albanian diaspora communities across Europe and North America.

The Albanian Government, led by Prime Minister Edi Rama, has consistently defended the project as a strategic investment for tourism and economic development, rejecting calls to suspend construction. At the same time, the Special Prosecution Against Corruption and Organized Crime office in Albania has opened an investigation into the land ownership and procedures related to the proposed tourism development.

Movement overview

- **30+ consecutive days** of coordinated peaceful protests across Albania.
- **30+ Albanian diaspora cities** organizing coordinated solidarity demonstrations across Europe and North America.
- **Tens of thousands of participants** mobilized through daily demonstrations, marches and public events.
- **Multiple legal complaints and court actions** filed by environmental organizations and civil society groups.

What the protesters demand

1. The resignation of the Government of Albania.
2. The repeal of the 2024 amendments to the Law on Protected Areas.
3. The repeal of the Strategic Investors legal framework.
4. The repeal of the Mountains Package (Paketa e Maleve).
5. The repeal of the amendments to the Law on Cultural Heritage.

On 17 June 2026, the European Parliament echoed several of these concerns by calling for the repeal of the 2024 amendments to the Law on Protected Areas and an immediate moratorium on new construction within protected areas.

Despite these calls from the European Parliament, environmental organizations, scientists and civil society, the Albanian Government has not taken any steps to restore the previous legal protections or address the transparency and environmental concerns raised throughout the movement.

Protect Vjosa-Narta!

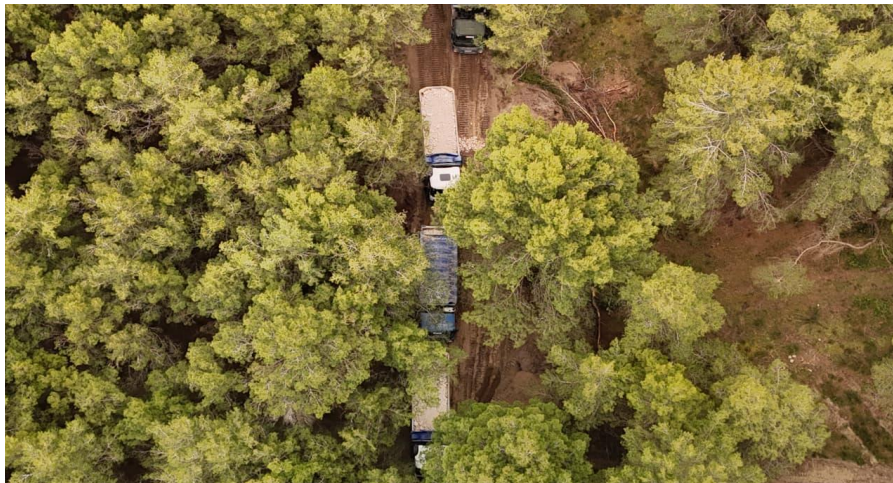
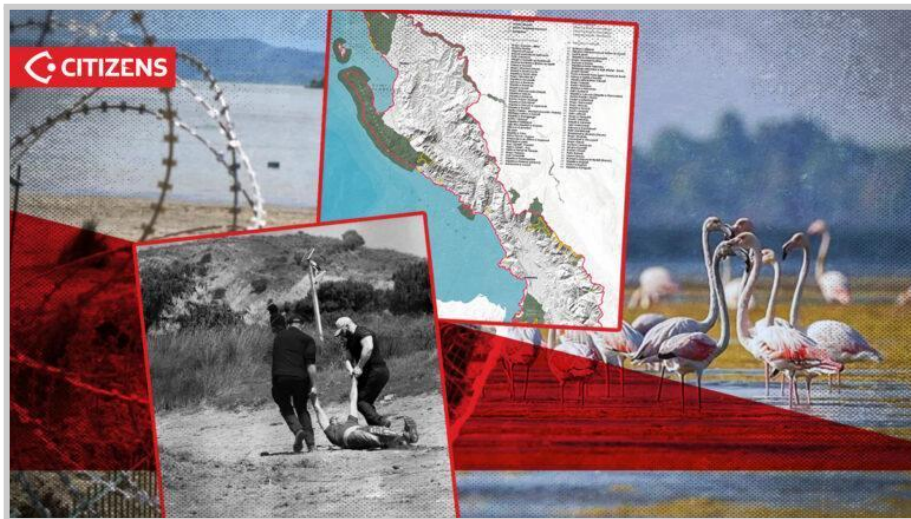
References

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3. PPNEA. "Save Vjosa-Narta." - <https://ppnea.org/save-vjosa-narta/?lang=en>
4. BirdLife International. Narta Lagoon Factsheet. - <https://datazone.birdlife.org/site/factsheet/2903-narta-lagoon>
5. Le Monde. "Europe's last natural delta threatened by plans for luxury tourism development." - https://www.lemonde.fr/en/environment/article/2024/06/17/in-albania-europe-s-last-natural-delta-threatened-by-donald-trump-s-son-in-law-s-plans_6674966_114.html
6. Citizens Channel. "Dhuna në Zvernec ndez protestën në Tiranë." - <https://citizens.al/2026/05/31/shqiperia-nuk-shitet-dhuna-ne-zvernec-ndez-protesten-ne-tirane/>
7. Mbro natyrën. <https://mbrotyren.europeishere.al/>
8. European Parliament backs the movement's mission. <https://www.birdlife.org/news/2026/06/17/press-release-european-parliament-backs-nature-as-albanias-flamingo-revolution-reaches-strasbourg/>.
9. Contradictions between what the government says and what has been already documented. <https://narta-ten.vercel.app/#top>
10. The Albanian Files - proof that most of the architectural projects in Albania are supported by the prime minister's own office with disregard to any public process. <https://citizens.al/en/2026/06/25/the-albanian-files-harta-e-resorteve-mbi-natyren-shqiptare/>
11. Documents proving that there is a project, even though government does not support that narrative. https://archive.org/details/sazan-2-clean/Sazan1_clean/

Appendix A: Timeline

Year	Key developments
2015	Law No. 55/2015 "On Strategic Investments" enters into force, establishing fast-track procedures and special legal status for projects designated as Strategic Investments.
2021	Construction begins on Vlora International Airport within the Vjosa–Narta Protected Landscape. Environmental organizations, scientists and international conservation bodies raise concerns and initiate legal challenges over its environmental impacts.
2023	Construction of the airport continues. Albania establishes the Vjosa Wild River National Park, while the Bern Convention and environmental organizations continue to warn about the cumulative impacts on the Vjosa–Narta ecosystem.
2024	The Government announces plans for large-scale luxury tourism developments on Sazan Island and in Zvërnec. Parliament amends the Law on Protected Areas (Law No. 81/2017), allowing certain tourism and strategic investment activities within protected areas. Environmental organizations argue that the amendments weaken long-standing environmental safeguards.
2025	The Sazan development receives Strategic Investor status under Law No. 55/2015. Parliament adopts Law No. 20/2025 ("Mountain Package"), further expanding opportunities for tourism development. Environmental organizations intensify legal challenges, petitions and public campaigns.
2026	Construction activities begin in the Zvërnec area as part of the planned tourism development. The project triggers one of Albania's largest environmental movements, with more than 30 consecutive days of protests, demonstrations in 30+ Albanian diaspora cities, legal challenges and international advocacy. On 17 June 2026, the European Parliament calls for the repeal of the 2024 amendments to the Law on Protected Areas and an immediate moratorium on new construction within protected areas.

Appendix B: Pictures from the works and the protests.



Copyrights: Fig B1. Poster for protests by [Citizens.al](https://citizens.al). Fig B2. B3. B4. Figures of the construction works by [PPNEA.org](https://ppnea.org)



Copyrights: Fig B5. B6. B7. B8. Protests as shared by [Citizens.al](https://www.instagram.com/citizens.al/) (Instagram).

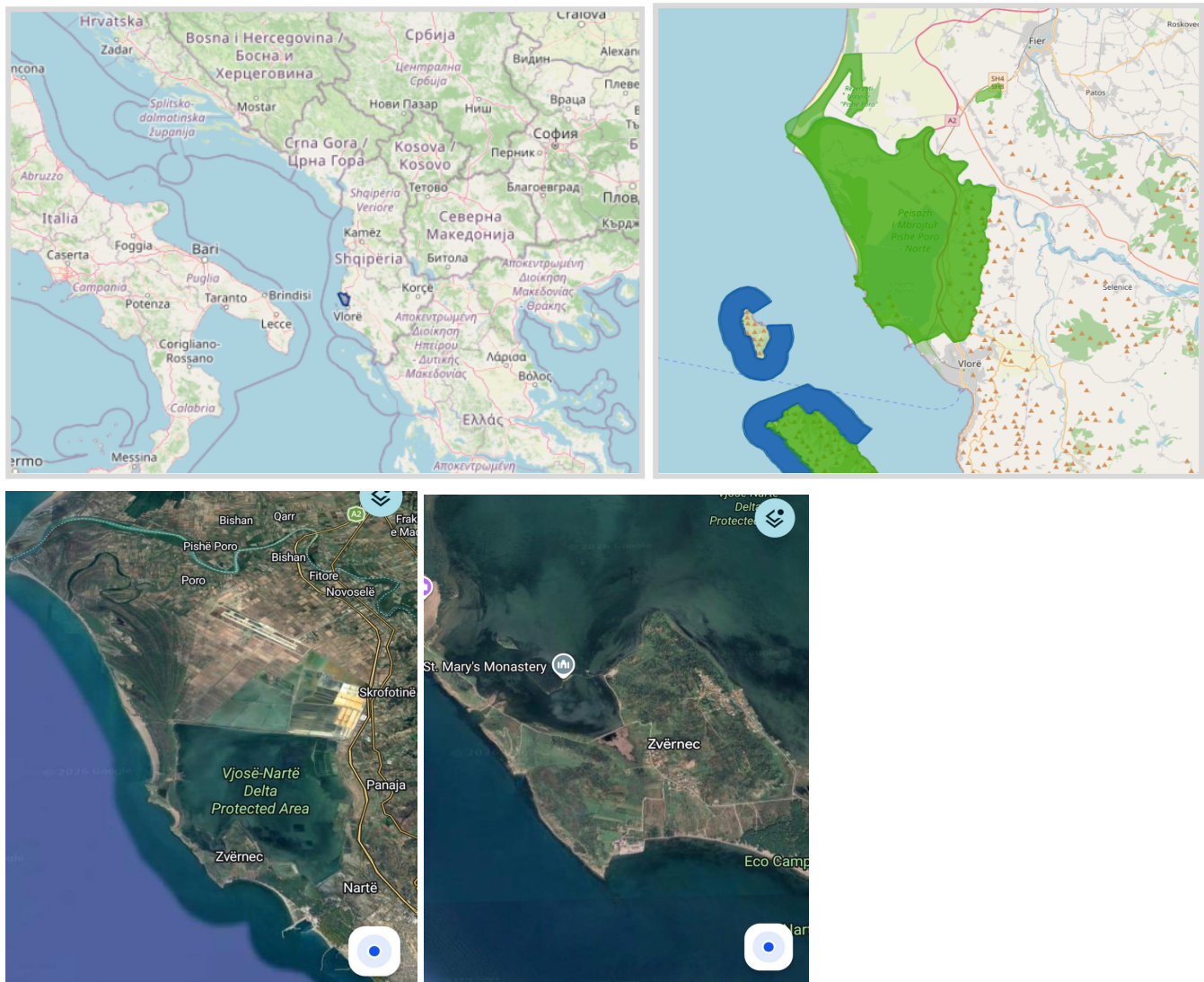
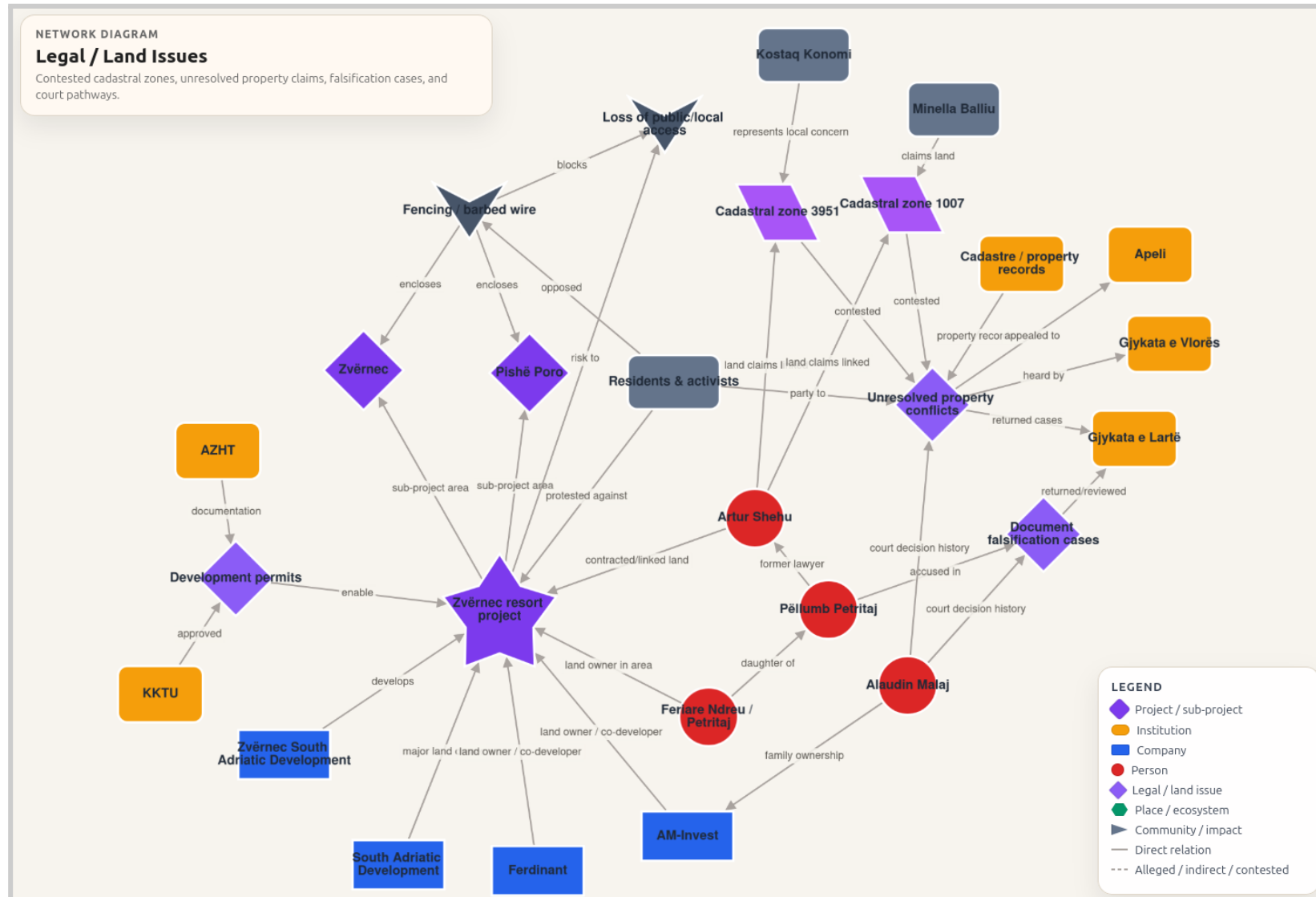


Fig B9. Fig B10. Protected Area of Pishë Poro-Nartë - OpenStreetMap, Birdlife International. [Birdlife.org](https://www.birdlife.org).
 Fig B11. Fig B12. Google maps view of the area.

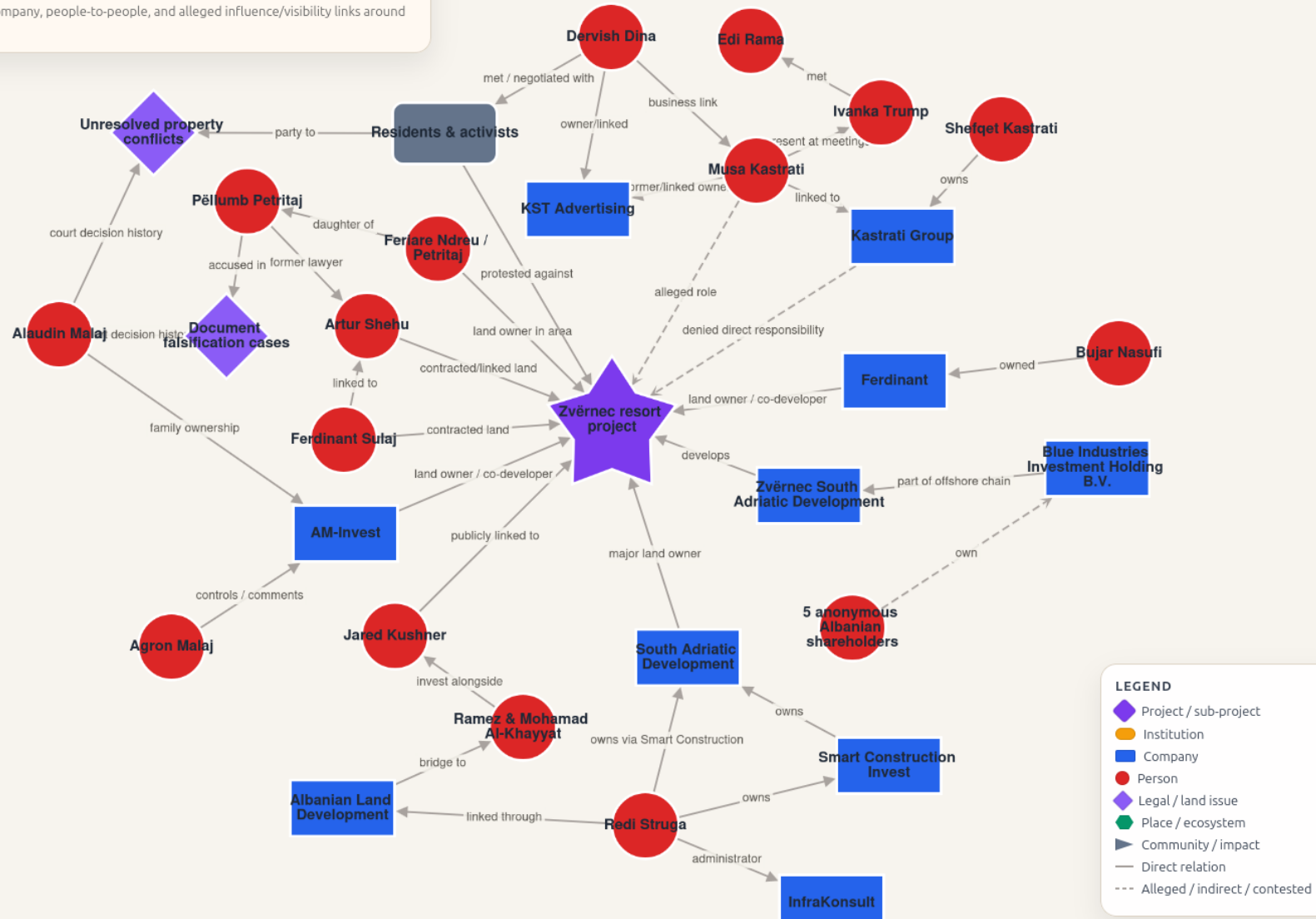
Appendix C: Relations and dependencies (Source: Ref 1 - BIRN).



NETWORK DIAGRAM

Personal Connections

People-to-company, people-to-people, and alleged influence/visibility links around the project.



Appendix D: One proposal for the project (unconfirmed).

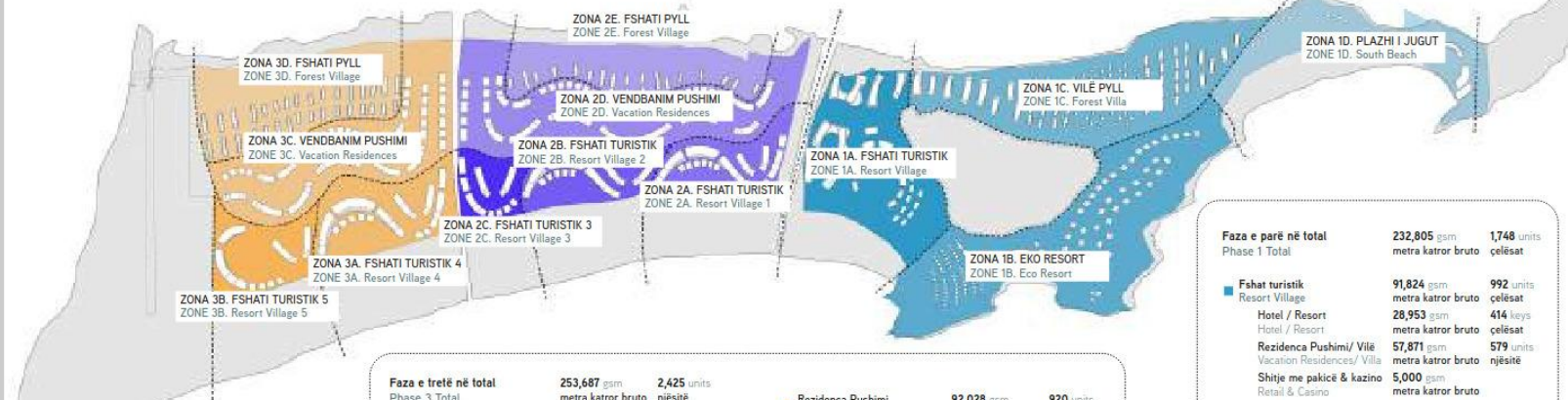
ZONIMI PROGRAMATIK

Programmatic Zoning

Faza e parë në total	232,805 metra katror bruto	1,748 çelësat
Faza e dytë në total	268,675 metra katror bruto	2,864 çelësat
Faza e tretë në total	253,687 metra katror bruto	2,425 çelësat
Zhvillimi Total	755,168 metra katror bruto	7,037 çelësat
Phase One Total	232,805 gsm	1,748 units
Phase Two Total	268,675 gsm	2,864 units
Phase Three Total	253,687 gsm	2,425 units
Total Development	755,168 gsm	7,037 units

Faza e dytë në total	268,675 gsm	2,864 units
Phase 2 Total	metra katror bruto	çelësat
Fshat turistik 1	57,761 gsm	735 units
Resort Village 1	metra katror bruto	çelësat
Hotel / Resort	36,643 gsm	523 keys
Hotel / Resort	metra katror bruto	çelësat
Rezidenca Pushimi/ Vilë	21,118 gsm	211 units
Vacation Residences/ Villa	metra katror bruto	njësitë
Fshat turistik 2	54,273 gsm	712 units
Resort Village 2	metra katror bruto	çelësat
Hotel / Resort	39,493 gsm	564 units
Hotel / Resort	metra katror bruto	njësitë
Rezidenca Pushimi/ Vilë	14,780 gsm	148 units
Vacation Residences/ Villa	metra katror bruto	njësitë
Fshat turistik 3	30,492 gsm	305 units
Resort Village 3	metra katror bruto	njësitë
Rezidenca Pushimi/ Vilë	30,492 gsm	305 units
Vacation Residences/ Villa	metra katror bruto	njësitë

Rezidenca Pushimi	102,546 gsm	1,025 units
Vacation Residences	metra katror bruto	njësitë
Rezidenca Pushimi/ Vilë	102,546 gsm	1,025 units
Vacation Residences/ Villa	metra katror bruto	njësitë
Fshati pyll	23,604 gsm	87 units
Forest Village	metra katror bruto	njësitë
Rezidenca Pushimi/ Vilë	23,604 gsm	87 units
Vacation Residences/ Villa	metra katror bruto	njësitë



Faza e tretë në total	253,687 gsm	2,425 units
Phase 3 Total	metra katror bruto	njësitë
Fshat turistik 4	73,572 gsm	926 units
Resort Village 4	metra katror bruto	njësitë
Hotel / Resort	44,506 gsm	636 keys
Hotel / Resort	metra katror bruto	çelësat
Rezidenca Pushimi/ Vilë	29,066 gsm	291 units
Vacation Residences/ Villa	metra katror bruto	njësitë
Fshat turistik 5	40,978 gsm	451 units
Resort Village 5	metra katror bruto	çelësat
Hotel / Resort	21,198 gsm	303 keys
Hotel / Resort	metra katror bruto	çelësat
Rezidenca Pushimi/ Vilë	14,780 gsm	148 units
Vacation Residences/ Villa	metra katror bruto	njësitë
Shitje me pakicë & kazino	5,000 gsm	metra katror bruto
Retail & Casino	metra katror bruto	

Rezidenca Pushimi	92,028 gsm	920 units
Vacation Residences	metra katror bruto	njësitë
Rezidenca Pushimi/ Vilë	92,028 gsm	920 keys
Vacation Residences/ Villa	metra katror bruto	çelësat
Fshati pyll	47,109 gsm	128 units
Forest Village	metra katror bruto	njësitë
Rezidenca Pushimi/ Vilë	47,109 gsm	128 keys
Vacation Residences/ Villa	metra katror bruto	çelësat

Faza e parë në total	232,805 gsm	1,748 units
Phase 1 Total	metra katror bruto	çelësat
Fshat turistik	91,824 gsm	992 units
Resort Village	metra katror bruto	çelësat
Hotel / Resort	28,953 gsm	414 keys
Hotel / Resort	metra katror bruto	çelësat
Rezidenca Pushimi/ Vilë	57,871 gsm	579 units
Vacation Residences/ Villa	metra katror bruto	njësitë
Shitje me pakicë & kazino	5,000 gsm	metra katror bruto
Retail & Casino	metra katror bruto	
Eko Resort	35,694 gsm	120 units
Eco Resort	metra katror bruto	çelësat
Hotel / Resort	13,394 gsm	79 keys
Hotel / Resort	metra katror bruto	çelësat
Rezidenca Pushimi/ Vilë	22,300 gsm	41 units
Vacation Residences/ Villa	metra katror bruto	njësitë
Fshati pyll	93,260 gsm	557 units
Forest Village	metra katror bruto	çelësat
Rezidenca Pushimi/ Vilë	93,260 gsm	557 units
Vacation Residences/ Villa	metra katror bruto	njësitë
Plazhi në jug	12,027 gsm	78 units
South Beach	metra katror bruto	çelësat
Hotel / Resort	5,481 gsm	78 keys
Hotel / Resort	metra katror bruto	çelësat
Shitje me pakicë & kazino	6,546 gsm	metra katror bruto
Retail & Casino	metra katror bruto	